2025-11-23 — סיום תחנון and Opening the ארון קודש: Shomer Yisrael, Kel Erech Apayim, and Brich Shmei

Independent review · read fresh from the HTML alone, no transcript consulted · 25 October 2026 · first full draft (as corrected once)

1.Overall Read

An eleven-section write-up of roughly 4,700 words with a twenty-eight-note *Mareh Mekomos*, built as a walk through the end of the weekday morning prayer: שומר ישראל, the close of אל תזכר, אל נדע, ואנחנו לא תחנון, the half קדיש, the open ארון, קל ארך אפים, ויהי בנסוע, and בריך שמיה. The best parts are the Lisker's reading of אל תזכר (Section IV), Rabbeinu Manoach's half קדיש (V), and the קל ארך אפים argument (VII-VIII) that ends in a clear instruction. The write-up reads as a spoken talk: lively, but the spoken order and the reportage voice make some stretches loose.

The hard problems are five. (a) **Section VII is about a third of the piece and carries three reasons, a long Italian aside and the Avudraham in one unbroken run**; the aside on נוסח בני רומי and the museum (about 300 words) delays the answer. (b) **The piece has no throughline about the open ארון.** Section VI introduces the עת רצון, then VII-VIII are about words said at that moment, and IX-XI return to it; the reader is not told that all of this is the same minute. (c) **The reportage voice** ("the Rav says," a participant, "we spoke about it") crowds the narrative. (d) **Several sources are cited without a locus** (the Chida, כתר שם טוב, the Rokeach, the Gaon on Italy), and the notes admit it; a reader will want to know which are checked. (e) **The ending is thin:** after the Rav Ram Shor story the piece closes with one paragraph on silence and a note about next week.

2.What Works

- **The three postures (III).** "We stood, we sat, we fell" gives the reader the reason for ואנחנו לא נדע in four sentences, and the halachah (sit for the first words, stand for the second) follows naturally.
- **The Lisker's reading (IV).** Rivkah's veil, David's alarm clock, "a king's first job is parnassah," and the two first questions of the heavenly court fit together into one idea, and the hard sentence ("a poor excuse, but at least a small excuse") is kept.
- **Rabbeinu Manoach (V).** The train to the city is the best example in the piece and answers the question the section asks.
- **"Say both" (VII).** The fifty words (forty plus ten) are set out clearly, the Avudraham's two explanations of his name are charming, and the Rav's "בלי נדר, fourteen seconds" is a good turn.
- **The Rav Ram Shor story (X).** The shift from אנא עבדא to אנא מבעי למהוי עבדא and the Rav's own wince is the emotional center of the piece.
- **The apparatus is candid.** Notes 5, 9, 13, 14, 23, 25, 26 each correct a locus or say that the passage was not found, and the body is not altered.

3.Where It's Weak or Could Be Sharper

Section VII needs sub-headings and a shorter aside. Seven strands in about 1,500 words: the unique two-version phenomenon, the latecomer reason, the Gaon and Italy, משח בני רומי and the Jerusalem museum, the Machzor Vitry, the Rokeach, and the Avudraham. Sub-headings (first, second and third reason; why two versions) are half-present as bold lead-ins. The aside on the Roman rite and the Museum of Italian Jewry should be cut to a short paragraph.

State once why the open ארון frames everything. VI says it is an עת רצון; VII and VIII then comment on what is said at that moment. A single

sentence at the top of VII ("The words that fill this moment are the next subject") and one at the top of IX would give the reader a throughline.

Two readings of זכר תזכר are not distinguished. The body gives the siddur's זכר תזכור in the heading and text while note 6 quotes the verse as תזכר זכר (Tehillim 79:8); the reader should be told once that these are the siddur's and the verse's forms.

The "Italian" difficulty is left unresolved in the body. The Gaon attributes the prayer to the sages of Italy; the Rav then says the מחזור בני רומי lacks it. The body says "perhaps a regional variant, perhaps a manuscript tradition," which is fair, but the reader needs the conclusion in one sentence: the identification is unresolved.

Asides to the room. A few sentences are addressed to the room ("Do you recognize those words?", "Has anyone ever davened in the Great Synagogue of Rome?"); in a book they should become statements or be cut.

The Sabbatean remark. "We will discuss it more next week" is promised in the body but the closing paragraph announces different topics for next week; the promise should be removed.

Reportage voice. "The Rav" and "the lecturer" open many paragraphs. The Sefer Edition should turn the lomdus (Rabbeinu Manoach, the three reasons, the Avudraham) into direct exposition and keep "the lecturer says" for opinions and stories.

4.Citations and Internal Consistency

- **Note 1 and note 19** give the Machzor Vitry and Siddur Rashi dates; note 1 says "Date and place … as given on Sefaria," which is a source statement and not a fact; consider "c. 1080–1120" only.
- **Notes 7 and 14** are honest about the Lisker and the Chida. Note 28

attributes to the Chida a position the Rav does not give; this has been softened.

- **Note 16** (כתר שם טוב, "first ed. Zolkiew 1794") gives a compiler (R. Aharon of Opatow) and a place that the Rav does not give; flag as editorial.
  - **Note 20** says the villagers read the Megillah on the day they come to the city; true to the Mishnah, but the Rav does not say it.
  - **Note 25** corrects the printing place; a reader should see "Mantua" in the body as well. The Sefer Edition does this.
- **Headings.** Section IV is titled אל תזכור; the footnote quotes the verse form. Pick one.
  - **"Two Sundays ago" in the lead and the opening** is a timing reference a book reader will not follow; the Sefer Edition says "two Sundays earlier."

5.Consolidated Recommended Edits (for the Sefer Edition rewrite)

1. Sub-head Section VII (four sub-headings) and shorten the Roman-rite and museum aside.
2. Add one throughline sentence about the open ארון before the קל ארך אפים section and before בריך שמיה.
3. Put the corrections (Mantua; about 1100) in the body beside the Rav's words.
4. Remove participants' names and the "next week" promise.
5. Turn the lomdus into direct exposition; keep the Rav's stories and quips as reports.
6. Close on the Rav Ram Shor story and the instruction to be silent, not on a note about next week.

7. Add an Open Questions block (Gaon and Italy; the Lisker; the Chida; the Magen Avraham; the Rambam on sitting).

6.Bottom Line

> *A lively, well-ordered write-up of a long shiur with a strong center (the Lisker, the half ש, the fifty words, עבדא ,) and an apparatus that is honest about what it could not find. As a web page it works. The weakest points are the overlong ארך אפים section, the lack of a throughline about the open ן, and a thin ending. With sub-headings, a shorter Italian aside, two bridging sentences and a stronger close, it would stand as a Sefer Edition chapter.*

Independent editorial review of the English write-up only. The reviewer read the HTML as a stranger would and did not consult the recording, the transcripts, or the earlier reviews. *caveat lector*.